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Bearing The Burden

In a quiet, dreamy, and darkened house, only sounds of snores and dreams filled the room. In a heartbeat, a “Bang” followed along with some unintelligible mutters, managed to rouse the dosing elders.

Her mom was awoken, then her eyes met Xylia’s. By her expression, she’s waiting for an answer.

“Bye, Mom! I’m leaving!” Xylia called as she slammed her door shut.

“Where are you going, sweetie?” her mom asked.

“Just going out with my friends. I’ll be back before dinner!” Xylia replied.

“Just make sure you stay safe, alright?” her mom reminded her.

Then she went out and closed the door. It was the school holiday, so Xylia decided to meet up with her friends at the park.

“Hey, guys!” Xylia waved as she walked toward her friends.

”Yo, Xylia! Took you long enough,” Ethan called with a grin.

“Perfect timing,” Mia said with a smirk. “We’re about to try something we’ve never done before.”

“What exactly is that?” Xylia hesitated.

“Alright, but don’t freak out.”

“So basically...” Ethan grinned. “You see that old warehouse over there? We kinda decided to check it out.”

They discussed merrily, and the others followed in.

“And you’re coming with us,” Noah added. “Don’t worry it’s gonna be fun.”

Xylia stared at the warehouse for a second before finally agreeing. “Alright... I’ll come with you guys.”

“Alright guys, let’s go!” Kai exclaimed, his grin growing wider as they finally started moving.

“The last one to arrive is a loser!” Ethan shouted before taking off.

The others laughed and sprinted after him. Xylia only jogged behind them, not really trying to keep up.

Before long, the group arrived at the old warehouse. The building looked worn down, with cracked walls and dusty windows. It seemed like nobody had been there for years. Ethan carefully pushed the old door open. It creaked loudly as the group stepped inside.

Everyone except Xylia started searching around in an instant. Xylia just stood there, watching them find old, dusty, worn-out items.

“Guys, check this out!” Noah called.

The others rushed over to look. It turned out to be nothing more than an old, dusty toolbox.

Xylia let out a quiet sigh. She was starting to lose interest.

Xylia watched them for a while before speaking. “Um... do you guys maybe want to do something else instead?”

“Don’t be such a coward, Xylia, you agreed to come in with us,” Mia told Xylia.

While looking around, Ethan steps on loose, rotten floorboards and falls through to a lower basement level, injuring his leg. The group panics and some of them decide to run away to avoid getting grounded or blamed for trespassing.

Xylia was left with two choices: run away to protect herself from getting into trouble, or stay and help Ethan even though he made a bad choice. Xylia thought hard until suddenly, she remembered the Bible verse from Galatians 6:2 saying, *“Bear ye one another’s burdens, and so fulfil the law of Christ.”*

The verse reminded her that following God meant helping others, even when it wasn’t easy. Xylia decided to choose compassion over fear, knowing that God would be pleased if she helped one another.

Xylia stayed to comfort Ethan, and called her mother for help, admitting she was trespassing. Her mother came to assist them, helping them get out of that place, and aiding the injury. Knowing that she and her friends did bad things, Xylia accepted her punishment with humility, but her honesty and compassion earned the respect of her friends and transformed their attitudes and made them avoid doing the same kind of mistakes.